unit 1

ا

alif

ـا

'a' in father when long

unit 1



ب

be

ب ـبـ ـب

'b' in bat

unit 1



ک

kāf

ک ـکـ ـک

'k' in kite

unit 1



ل

lām

ل ـلـ ـل

'l' in log

unit 1



م

mīm

م ـمـ ـم

'm' in mat

unit 1



ن

nūn

ن ـنـ ـن

'n' in net

unit 2

3

ت

te

ت ـتـ ـت

soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth (Spanish 'tú')

unit 2



ی

choṭī ye

ی ـیـ ـی

'y' in yes at the start

unit 2

ے

baṛī ye

ے

'ay' in day

unit 3



پ

pe

پ ـپـ ـپ

'p' in pat

unit 3



ٹ

ṭe

ٹ ـٹـ ـٹ

hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back

unit 3



ث

s̱e

ث ـثـ ـث

's' in sun (Arabic loanwords only)

unit 4

و

wāʾo

و

'w'/'v' at the start

unit 4



ر

re

ر

tapped 'r' (Spanish 'pero')

unit 4

2

د

dāl

د

soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth

unit 4



ہ

choṭī he (gol he)

ہ ـہـ ـہ

'h' in hat

unit 5



س

sīn

س سـ ـسـ ـس

's' in sun

unit 5



ش

shīn

ش شـ ـشـ ـش

'sh' in shop

unit 5



ج

jīm

ج جـ ـجـ ـج

'j' in jam

unit 5

4

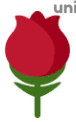
چ

che

چ چـ ـچـ ـچ

'ch' in chair

unit 5



گ

gāf

گ گـ ـگـ ـگ

'g' in go

unit 6

ں

nūn g̲hunna

ں

nasalises the vowel before it, like French 'bon'

unit 6



ھ

do-chashmī he

ھ ھـ ـھـ

a puff of breath after the letter before it: بھ bh, پھ ph, کھ kh, گھ gh...

unit 7



ڈ

ḍāl

ڈ

hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back

unit 7



ڑ

ṛe

ڑ

a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)

unit 7



ز

ze

ز

'z' in zoo

unit 7



ژ

zhe

ژ

's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)

unit 8



ف

fe

ف ـفـ ـف

'f' in fat

unit 8



ق

qāf

ق ـقـ ـق

a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 8



خ

k̲he

خ ـخـ ـخ

'ch' in Scottish loch

unit 8



غ

g̲hain

غ ـغـ ـغ

a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'

unit 8



ع

ʻain

ع ـعـ ـع

in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel written around it (عمر umar)

unit 8

ح

baṛī ḥe

ح ـحـ ـح

'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 9



ص

ṣwād

ص ـصـ ـص

's' in sun

unit 9



ض

ẓwād

ض ـضـ ـض

'z' in zoo

unit 9



ط

ṭo'e

ط ـطـ ـط

soft 't'

unit 9

ظ

ẓo'e

ظ ظـ ظـ

'z' in zoo

unit 9



ذ

ẕāl

ذ

'z' in zoo

unit 10

ىٔ

hamza

ىٔ ـئـ ـئ

a tiny break between two vowels (کوئی ko-ī). It rides on ی as ئ, on و as ؤ, or stands alone…